

FAITH THROUGH TRIALS

By Laura Cullen and Paige Chambers

Nahalath stumbles on stage, pulling a sack of animal food. It is heavy, so she is changing its position often. Eventually she drops it on her toe and yells in pain.

Nahalath: Arathka! Help!

Arathka rushes in, arms full of washing. As she gets closer to Nahalath, a piece of clothing dangles from her arms and she trips on it, falling over at Nahalath's feet. Nahalath laughs at her behind her hand.

Arathka: I come over here to help you, and then you laugh at me! What is the world coming to!

Nahalath: Hopefully dry land.

Arathka: It's not funny, Nahalath! We've been stuck on this stuffy boat—

Nahalath: Ark.

Arathka: Whatever—for a whole day now, and you're getting really irritating.

Nahalath: Just help me please?

Arathka glances at the one sack of animal feed and makes a face.

Arathka: Really? One bag?

Nahalath: It's really heavy, okay?

Arathka sighs as they grab one end each and begin to tug and pull the sack across the floor.

Arathka: Do you think we'll ever get off this ship, Nahalath?

Nahalath: Ark.

Arathka: Get over it!

Nahalath: All I know is that we need to trust God, because He has a plan, and his plans always turn out for good.

Arathka: You're very wise, Nahalath.

Nahalath: I think Shem has rubbed off on me.

Arathka: Oh dear. That's a little scary.

Nahalath: (laughing) I know.

Arathka: I give up.

They drop the sack and sit on it dejectedly.

Nahalath: Has it really only been a day?

Arathka: Sadly, yes.

Nahalath: Wow. This is going to get old.

Arathka: I know. Those chimpanzees are already giving me a headache!

They laugh.

Nahalath: Well, I was feeding the hippos and one of them burped up stale fish breath in my face! How do you feel for me!?

Arathka assumes a knowing expression.

Arathka: Well, I've fed the hippos three days in a row now, so...

Nahalath gives her a disbelieving look.

Nahalath: We've only been here for one day. You just said so yourself.

Arathka:(confused) Oh, yeah.

-a pause-

Arathka: Why wouldn't they believe me?

Nahalath: I don't know. But you did your best. They didn't listen, and God punished them for that. You're not guilty because they decided to disregard Noah's warning.

Arathka: I don't feel guilty. I just feel sad.

Nahalath: I know. But it'll get better.

Arathka: How do you know?

Nahalath: Well, if we... keep hope, and... keep busy...

Arathka is looking at her with raised eyebrows.

Arathka: Apparently Shem still has some work to do.

Nahalath: I tried, okay!

Arathka: So, you really are my age under all the 100-year-old granny wisdom?

Nahalath: Don't dis 100-year-old grannies!

They laugh.

-pause-

Arathka: Stupid chimpanzees.

Nahalath shakes her head.

Nahalath: Of all the creatures God could have invented, He made massive, hairy, ear-drum bursting, ... things.

Arathka grins, then is suddenly serious.

Arathka: But we're not questioning him.

Nahalath: No, of course not.

Arathka: We're going to trust that there's a reason for hairy, ear-drum bursting... things, just like there's a reason why God flooded the entire world bar this floating boat—

Nahalath: Ark.

Arathka: Whatever, and killed a whole lot of semi-innocent people.

Nahalath frowns, thinking about that.

Nahalath: But, they were horrible people. That's kind of why God flooded the entire world.

Arathka: Well, my family wasn't horrible.

Nahalath: I think that's a matter of opinion.

Arathka: Whoa, brutal. *Takes a deep breath* So, we trust that God had His reasons for creating chimpanzees, and we trust that He had His reasons for flooding the world and killing everyone, innocent or not, but... just because we trust He has a plan doesn't mean we can't be... well, afraid, right?

Nahalath: Of course not. We're human, and God knows that. All that He asks of us is that we believe He has a plan and then that we act on that faith. Like we did when Shem and Japheth told us that Noah was building an oversized fishing boat because God told him—

Arathka: And we married them anyway!

Nahalath: Um... and then when we actually got on the Ark—

Arathka: Even though we knew Noah had issues with his plumbing skills!

Nahalath: Oh, yeah... yeah, that was... that was kind of disgusting.

Arathka: It was more than disgusting! It was downright revolting! And Zedkat just stood there and said, "Ew, that is like, like so gross—"

Nahalath: Okay, we, we're not going to dis Ham's choice of a wife—

Arathka: I am!

Nahalath: Well, just keep your—

Arathka: She never helps us do anything! She just sits there talking, and never so much as lifts a finger to do anything productive, and she complains about how loud the animals are, and how heavy the sacks are for her petite, delicate little form, and—

Nahalath: Arathka!

Arathka: What!?!

Nahalath Just take a good long look at... you know, everything you've said for like, the past minute.

Arathka sits in silence for a few moments.

Arathka: Huh.

-another pause-

Arathka: So, what were we talking about?

Nahalath: We were talking about faith and trusting God.

Arathka: Oh, right, (nervous laugh) Of course. *sighs*. I guess we should probably do something about this sack.

Nahalath: Yeah, wouldn't want Zedkat to come and see us lying down on the job. (looks meaningfully at Arathka, who pretends not to notice, and whistles sheepishly)

They get up and pick up the sack and begin to lift it.

Arathka: I've got it! The hippos came two days early! I knew I'd fed them three times!

Arathka has dropped the sack on Nahalath's foot, who is making faces in an effort not to scream.

Arathka: What? Oh, sorry.

They pick up the sacks and stumble off stage.